ADVIZEN

GUIDE FOR FOREIGN INVESTORS

Setting Up a Company in Uzbekistan

Legal forms, registration and the first steps of a foreign-owned company

2026

advizenco.com · info@advizenco.com · +998 33 488 48 88

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AT A GLANCE

What changed in 2026

Registration now takes minutes. The time goes into what comes before and after it: documents, digital identity of the founders, bank checks and licences.

A new LLC law. Since 22 July 2026 limited liability companies are governed by Law ZRU-1137. It keeps the LLC flexible: no general minimum capital, up to 50 participants and any person with full legal capacity as director.

Business in 15 minutes. Since 1 January 2026, under Decree UP-214, the e-signature key, the bank account application, a licence application, the VAT certificate and other services can be ordered in the same registration application.

Small business tax. Since 1 June 2026 turnover tax is available up to annual income of 12,000 BCV, and trade, catering and services may opt for a simplified 6% VAT.

Beneficial owners. The registration application now includes a questionnaire on the individual who ultimately owns or controls the company.

Lighter licensing. Licence decisions are due within 20 working days, silence of the authority counts as consent, and refusal is possible only on five listed grounds. For activities listed by the Cabinet of Ministers, a business may start without a licence for three months.

Director checks. Since 1 July 2026 the registry checks the proposed director against court bans and other official databases.

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30 min
Registration time limit by law, once the file is complete and the duty paid

1–50
Participants in an LLC, companies or individuals of any nationality

15%
Minimum foreign share for foreign-investment enterprise status

20
Working days for the authority to decide on a licence

CHOOSING THE FORM

Three ways to be present in Uzbekistan

For most investors the answer is a subsidiary LLC. A representative office cannot trade, and a permanent establishment suits a single project or contract.

	Subsidiary LLC Uzbek legal entity	**Representative office** Accredited, not a legal entity	**Permanent establishment** Tax registration only
What it is	An Uzbek company that can be 100% foreign owned	An office of the foreign company accredited by the Ministry of Investment, Industry and Trade	The foreign company itself, registered with the tax authority for its activity in Uzbekistan
Commercial activity	Any lawful business, with a licence where one is required	Not allowed. Representative and auxiliary functions only	The work under its contracts in Uzbekistan
Timing	30 minutes by law once the file is complete. Allow 2 to 3 days in practice	Decision within 5 working days	Within 30 days when a contract runs longer than 183 days, otherwise within 183 days
Suits	Trade, services, production and hiring a team	Market research and liaison with partners	A construction site or a service contract without a local company

TWO FORMS THAT RARELY FIT

- **Branch.** Uzbek law has no procedure to register a branch of a foreign commercial company, and in practice such filings are refused. Use one of the three forms above
- **Joint stock company.** Required for a bank. Otherwise choose it only where sector rules call for it. Like the LLC, it has no general minimum capital

The LLC under the new law

Owners and capital

- **1 to 50 participants,** companies or individuals, with no nationality limits (Art. 8)
- **No general minimum capital.** A minimum applies only where licensing rules set one (Art. 15)
- Contributions are paid within the term in the charter, and no later than **one year** after registration
- Capital is stated in soums. It may be paid in foreign currency or in kind, and in-kind contributions above 10,000 BCV are valued by an appraiser

Management

- The general meeting of participants is the supreme body. A supervisory board is optional
- **Director:** any natural person with full legal capacity. No citizenship or residence requirement, and the director need not be a participant (Art. 42)
- Management can be passed to a managing company under a contract
- A company seal is not required

A SOLE FOREIGN PARENT

An LLC may not have as its only participant another company that itself has a single participant, unless that participant is a joint stock company with one shareholder (Art. 8). Whether this covers a foreign Ltd or GmbH with one shareholder is not settled. To be safe, add a second participant, such as another group company with a small stake, or hold the LLC through a parent with two or more shareholders.

Foreign-investment enterprise status

An LLC has this status when foreign investment is at least 15% of its capital and the capital is at least UZS 400 million, or UZS 200 million in Karakalpakstan and Khorezm. Below these figures the company registers as an ordinary LLC with foreign capital.

The status brings a 10-year guarantee against adverse changes in law, free transfer of funds abroad and land leases of up to 25 years (ZRU-598). Since 2026 the Tax Code offers only land and property tax relief, for a term set by the President, with a foreign share of at least 33% and further conditions (Arts. 471, 472).

PREPARATION

Before you file

Most of the time goes here. Foreign documents need an apostille and a translation, and online signers need an Uzbek e-signature.

Corporate founder

- ☐ Register extract and charter of the parent, ideally under six months old
- ☐ Decision to set up the Uzbek LLC
- ☐ Power of attorney for the local representative
- ☐ Apostille or legalisation, and a notarised translation into Uzbek or Russian

Director

- ☐ Passport
- ☐ PINFL, needed in practice for the e-signature, the labour system and the bank
- ☐ Right to work for a foreign director (page 8)

Individual founder

- ☐ Passport with a notarised translation
- ☐ PINFL, the personal identification number, issued at a Public Services Centre in 2–4 working days, also through a representative
- ☐ Personal Uzbek e-signature, if filing online
- ☐ Power of attorney, if a representative files

The Uzbek LLC

- ☐ Name in Latin script, reserved for 60 days
- ☐ Charter in Uzbek, no notary needed
- ☐ Foundation agreement for several participants
- ☐ Legal address in the tax and cadastre databases
- ☐ Beneficial owner details and tax regime

GOOD TO KNOW

- An e-signature is issued only to its holder in person, never by proxy
- Uzbekistan applies the Apostille Convention. Some states have objected to it, and their documents need consular legalisation

REGISTRATION

One application, one window

1

Name

A free name in Latin script, reserved for 60 days

2

Application

Online at my.gov.uz or in person at any Public Services Centre

3

Extra services

E-signature key, bank account, VAT certificate and others in the same filing

4

Duty

All services are paid with one QR code

5

Registered

Certificate with QR code, tax number and tax registration

30 minutes by law

Online or in person

Online, through my.gov.uz or birdarcha.uz, each founder who is not an Uzbek citizen must sign with an own Uzbek e-signature. In person, a representative with a power of attorney files at a Public Services Centre and signs on paper, without founder e-signatures. Most companies are registered this way.

By law the company is registered within 30 minutes of a complete, paid filing. In practice allow 2 to 3 days.

The extra services include the company e-signature key, the bank account application, a licence application, registration of the lease, the VAT certificate, an online cash register and appointment of the director in the labour system.

New checks in the application

A questionnaire names the beneficial owner, the individual who ultimately owns or controls the company, with passport details. The company undertakes to report changes.

Since 1 July 2026 registration is refused if the director is, for example, barred from business by a court, serving a prison sentence or on the terrorism list. Citizenship of the director is not a ground.

AFTER REGISTRATION

Bank, e-signature and tax regime

Bank account

The account application can go in with the registration, but remote opening is reserved for companies with Uzbek resident founders. A foreign-owned company goes through bank checks of its founders, parent and beneficial owners. The signatory, usually the director, signs the specimen card in person at the bank. The law does not require the owner to travel, though some banks ask. Allow one to three weeks, depending on the bank. Payments inside Uzbekistan are made in soums.

Company e-signature

The company key is issued to the director on the company's tax number and the director's PINFL, for up to 24 months. It signs e-invoices, labour contracts and licence applications. A new director gets a new key.

Tax regime

Regime	Main terms
Turnover tax	Instead of profit tax and VAT, while annual income stays below 12,000 BCV. Chosen in the registration application
Simplified 6% VAT	Trade, catering and services, until 2030. 6% of turnover without input VAT, 0% profit tax
General regime	15% profit tax and 12% VAT, with monthly VAT returns

Tax Code, Arts. 258, 337, 461–462, as changed by Decree UP-100 from 1 June 2026. Large taxpayers and companies with a state share of 50% or more cannot use the 6% option.

FROM THE FIRST SALE

- VAT payers hold a VAT certificate. It can be ordered at registration where it is issued automatically
- Invoices are issued in the state e-invoicing system (Tax Code, Art. 47)
- Sales to consumers usually require an online cash register, which can be ordered at registration
- The company must actually be at its legal address. If it is not, the tax authority can suspend operations on its accounts (Tax Code, Art. 111)

Director and staff

A foreign national may be director. If that person works in Uzbekistan, the company usually needs a confirmation of the right to work first.

Right to work

The employer obtains the confirmation from the Ministry of Poverty Reduction and Employment, which decides within 15 working days. It lasts up to three years for qualified specialists and up to one year for others (Law ZRU-642, Art. 107).

No confirmation needed for

- Foreigners who invested at least 8,500 BCV in the company, for any position in it
- Founders and first heads of foreign and joint enterprises, for up to three months
- Holders of an Uzbek residence permit
- Foreign specialists of IT Park residents
- Staff who work remotely from abroad

Contracts and payroll

- Every labour contract, change and termination is registered in the Unified National Labour System with the company e-signature
- The director can be appointed in that system as part of registration
- A director can later be changed online or at a Public Services Centre within minutes
- **12%** personal income tax, withheld by the employer
- **12%** social tax, paid by the employer on top of gross pay. There is no separate pension fund registration

IN PRACTICE

A director hired by a foreign parent usually needs the confirmation from the first day. The investor exemption is written for individuals who invested in the company themselves. Visas and registration of stay are handled separately.

Licences and sector limits

How licensing works

- Three regimes under Law ZRU-701: licence, permit or notification
- Applications only online, in the Litsenziya system or at my.gov.uz
- Decision within **20 working days**. The Cabinet may set longer terms for some activities
- If the authority misses the deadline, the business may start once it pays the fee, and the licence counts as issued
- Refusal only on five listed grounds. Defects can be cured and the file is reviewed again without a new fee
- Most licences have no expiry date

New in 2026

- **Entry without a licence.** For activities the Cabinet lists, a free notice allows three months of work while the licence is obtained
- **Preliminary assessment** of premises, equipment and staff in the Litsenziya system, with a result within 20 days
- Only the company, not its officers, is fined for licensing breaches
- A licence application can be filed together with registration

Limits for foreign-owned companies

- There is no general cap on foreign ownership. Limits come from sector laws
- **Land** can only be leased by foreign companies, for up to 25 years for a foreign-investment enterprise
- **Agricultural land:** since 1 May 2026 foreign persons and foreign-investment enterprises may not lease it directly, bid at auctions or acquire stakes in agricultural land users (Decree UP-68)
- **Banks** must be joint stock companies licensed by the Central Bank. **Mass media** have a cap on foreign participation
- Buying a large stake in an existing company may need prior antitrust clearance

REPRESENTATIVE OFFICE

An office without trading

A representative office is not a legal entity and may not carry on commercial activity. Since 2024 it is accredited under Cabinet of Ministers Resolution No. 76.

Accreditation

- By the Ministry of Investment, Industry and Trade, on an online application through my.gov.uz or a Public Services Centre
- Five documents: application, parent's constituent documents, proof of registration, power of attorney for the head, regulations of the office
- Notarised, translated into Uzbek or Russian, apostilled or legalised, and issued no more than six months before filing
- Decision within **5 working days**, certificate within one working day after the duty is paid
- For **one to three years,** at the applicant's choice

Operating rules

- No commercial activity. Going beyond the office’s regulations can end the accreditation
- Foreign staff up to 40% of headcount and no more than five people
- Registered for tax automatically on accreditation
- Pays social tax on staff pay. Activity beyond auxiliary functions can create a permanent establishment (Tax Code, Art. 36)
- No annual report. The Ministry may request information

THE PERMANENT ESTABLISHMENT ROUTE

A foreign company that performs a contract in Uzbekistan without a local entity registers with the tax authority as a permanent establishment. A building site or services lasting more than 183 days in any twelve months create one, while preparatory and auxiliary work does not. Registration is due within 30 days when a contract runs longer than 183 days, and otherwise within 183 days of starting work.

ROADMAP

From decision to first month

For a foreign founder the project usually takes two to six weeks. The documents abroad and the bank checks take longest.

Start	**Decision and structure** Form, participants, capital, foreign-investment status and tax regime
Days to weeks	**Documents abroad** Parent company documents and power of attorney, apostilled or legalised
In parallel	**PINFL and e-signatures** For founders who will sign online and for the director
A few days	**Translations and charter** Notarised translations, charter in Uzbek, name check and legal address
2 to 3 days	**Registration** Filing with the extra services. 30 minutes by law once the file is complete
1 to 3 weeks	**Bank account and company e-signature** Bank checks of owners, signatory in person at the bank
First month	**First operations** Labour contracts, right to work, licences, e-invoices and accounting. Capital paid within one year

OPEN POINTS WE CHECK CASE BY CASE

- Whether a sole foreign parent with one shareholder needs a second participant
- Whose e-signature signs an online filing for a corporate founder
- Whether the chosen bank onboards without a visit by the owner
- Whether the activity qualifies for the three-month start without a licence

HOW WE HELP

One team from decision to first month

We run the legal, tax and administrative side of the set-up, so that you can focus on the business you are building.

01 Structure choice

LLC, representative office or permanent establishment, participants, capital and foreign-investment status.

02 Documents and apostille

Checklist for the parent company, powers of attorney, apostille, translations and the charter.

03 Registration

Filing at a Public Services Centre as your representative, with the extra services you need.

04 Bank and e-signature

PINFL, e-signatures, bank selection and support through the bank checks.

05 Tax regime and accounting

Choice of regime, VAT, e-invoicing, bookkeeping and monthly filings from day one.

06 Licences and people

Licence applications, right to work for foreign staff and labour contracts.

CONTACTS

Planning to set up a company in Uzbekistan?

Tell us about your plans and the timeline. We answer in English, Russian, Uzbek or German. The first call is free.

Book an introductory call

WEBSITE

advizenco.com

EMAIL

info@advizenco.com

PHONE

+998 33 488 48 88

TELEGRAM

t.me/advizen

LOCATION

Tashkent, Uzbekistan

advizenco.com

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